Policy Title: Cultural Competency Plan for the Family Wellness Center
Date of Policy: May 3, 2024

Purpose:

The Family Wellness Center aims to enhance cultural awareness among management and staff, fostering an environment that embraces diversity. This plan outlines strategies to achieve cultural competence.

Training Components:

1. **Annual Staff Training**:
    - All staff members will receive annual training on cultural diversity dynamics.
    - Topics covered:
        - Understanding cultural differences
        - Creating a receptive environment
        - Sensitivity in interactions
2. **Management Training**:
    - Annual training for management to sensitize them to different minority backgrounds.
    - Focus on cultural sensitivity in employment practices (interviewing, hiring, and retention).
3. **Staff and Contract Personnel In-Service Trainings**:
    - Periodic trainings to:
        - Increase awareness of cultural similarities/differences among staff
        - Understand cultural patterns of minority consumers
        - Develop effective response techniques
4. **Specific Training Topics**:
    - Effects of psychiatric interventions on minority individuals (including psychotropic medications)
    - Differential diagnosis for ethnic minority persons
    - Vernacular language patterns of ethnic minorities
5. **Minimum Cultural Competency Hours**:
    - Staff and contract personnel must complete a minimum of eight (8) hours of cultural competency training annually.
    - Training certificates will be documented in personnel files.

Key Areas of Cultural Competence:

1. **Beliefs and Values**:
    - Acknowledge and respect diverse belief systems and values.
2. **Tradition and Lifestyle Practices**:
    - Understand and appreciate cultural traditions and lifestyle practices.
3. **Legal and Behavioral Norms**:
    - Familiarize staff with formal and informal rules of behavior across cultures.
4. **Dignity and Respect**:
    - Treat all consumers with dignity and respect, regardless of cultural background.
5. **Spirituality and Poverty**:
    - Recognize the impact of spirituality and poverty on well-being.
6. **Empowerment and Patienthood**:
    - Address power dynamics and empower consumers in their healthcare journey.
7. **Disability Awareness**:
    - Sensitize staff to the needs of individuals with disabilities.

Personal Evaluation:

Encourage self-reflection among staff to evaluate their own values regarding cultural diversity and responsiveness. This introspection is essential for fostering a culturally competent environment.

_____ _____

Chief Operating Officer **Date**